

Dear Stripe hiring team,

I've spent ten years building and shipping full-stack systems end to end, most recently as the engineer setting architecture and technical direction for a team. I want to put that toward solving ambiguous, high-stakes 0-to-1 problems for people building companies from scratch, like your job post described.

I currently lead a small engineering team, own architecture and hiring, and built the security framework that cleared agentic coding tools for production use. That work required aligning stakeholders and setting direction without formal authority over every team involved.

Outside my day job, I've built and shipped four E2E full-stack products solo, including a procedural web app with a custom Canvas render loop and its own auth and infrastructure provisioning, and a nightly data pipeline running unattended on a five-dollar VPS. I've built multiple apps on React/Typescript frontend, Node/Express and FastAPI backend services (with auth and rate-limiting), Postgres and Mongo schema, and the Terraform/CI infra underlaying it all. Each one required the same loop your post calls for: define the problem, make the architecture decisions, build it, keep it running. I don't have production Ruby experience, but I pick up backend languages fast, and I'd be pleased as punch to pickup Stripe's stack.

I'd welcome the chance to talk through how my experience can map onto your Startup Products' roadmap.

All the best,
Sander VanWilligen